CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP · TASK 2

Phishing Awareness Training

Spot it. Stop it. Report it.



What is phishing?

The bait

A message that looks like it came from a bank, a boss or a service you use: email, SMS, WhatsApp or a phone call.

The hook

A link, attachment or request that pushes you to act fast: log in, pay, or share a code.

The catch

Attackers steal passwords, money or identity, or plant malware on your device.

Phishing is fraud that targets people, not software.

How to spot a phishing email

Red flag	What it looks like
Odd sender address	support@mybank-secure.net instead of the real domain
Urgent tone	“Your account will be closed in 24 hours!”
Generic greeting	“Dear customer” instead of your name
Suspicious link	Hovering shows a different address than the text
Unexpected attachment	Invoice.zip, .exe or macro-enabled documents
Poor quality	Typos, blurry logos, strange formatting

Spotting fake websites

REAL

`https://www.mybank.com.pk`

FAKE: REAL NAME INSIDE A DIFFERENT DOMAIN

`https://mybank.com.pk.secure-login.net`

FAKE: LOOK-ALIKE LETTERS (RN VS M)

`https://www.rnybank.com.pk`

Quick checks

- Read the domain just before the first single slash
- A padlock only means encrypted, not trustworthy
- Type the address yourself or use a bookmark
- Be careful with shortened links

Social engineering tactics

Urgency

“Act now or your account closes.” Pressure leaves no time to think.

Authority

Posing as a manager, bank officer or government agency.

Fear

“Suspicious login detected!” Panic makes people click.

Reward

Prizes, refunds and free gifts that seem too good to be true.

Attackers manipulate emotions first, technology second.

Real-world examples

2016

Fake security alert

A spoofed Google sign-in warning led a US campaign chairman to enter his password. His emails were later leaked.

2013 TO 2015

Fake supplier invoices

A scammer posing as a hardware vendor billed Google and Facebook, which paid over $100 million before it was caught.

2020

Phone call to staff

Attackers posed as internal IT support, got employee credentials, and took over well-known Twitter accounts.

Even large tech companies are targeted. Anyone can be.

Best practices

- Pause before you click
- Verify through a second channel
- Turn on multi-factor authentication
- Use unique passwords and a password manager
- Keep system, browser and antivirus updated
- Never share OTPs or passwords with anyone

Clicked a suspicious link?

1. Stop. Enter nothing more and close the page.
2. Change the password you may have exposed, and any account that reuses it.
3. Turn on multi-factor authentication.
4. Run an antivirus scan.
5. Report it to your IT team, your bank or the platform, and to the FIA Cyber Crime Wing if money or identity is involved.

QUIZ 1 OF 3

An SMS says your bank account is blocked and asks you to verify through a short link. What do you do?

A. Tap the link and verify quickly

B. Reply with your account number

C. Ignore the link and contact the bank through its official app or number

Answer: C. Never act on a link in an unexpected message; use an official channel.

QUIZ 2 OF 3

Which web address is most likely fake?

A. https://www.mybank.com.pk

B. https://mybank.com.pk.secure-login.net

C. https://online.mybank.com.pk

Answer: B. The real domain is the part before the first single slash: secure-login.net.

QUIZ 3 OF 3

Your manager emails from a personal address and urgently asks you to buy gift cards. First step?

A. Buy them now, the boss is waiting

B. Check by calling or messaging your manager on a known channel

C. Forward the email to your colleagues

Answer: B. Urgency plus an unusual request is a classic authority scam: verify first.

Pause. Verify. Report.

If a message creates pressure, treat that pressure as the warning sign.

THANK YOU